

The diminishing value of a T20 century

From strike-rate thresholds to first-innings pressure, a deep statistical look at why hundreds in modern IPL cricket are **losing their old value.**

Pranay Rajiv

pranay.rajiv@thehindu.co.in



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A century is one of the most celebrated statistical milestones in cricket. For a sport that has historically favoured batters, a hundred is considered the perfect landmark, not too common, yet not too rare. Batters across generations have often been measured by the number of centuries they have scored. The idea of a batter moving from double digits to triple digits has long occupied a mythical position in the sport.

But in modern T20 cricket, with a sharply limited number of deliveries in an innings, the relevance of a hundred is fast dwindling.

The 2026 season of the Indian Premier League (IPL) has already seen six centurions end up on the losing side, the most in a single edition of the tournament.

Year-wise breakdown

There have been 123 hundreds in the Indian Premier League, and 73.17% of them have resulted in wins (90 wins vs 33 losses).

In the early years of the IPL, centuries in losing causes were rare and usually came in high-scoring thrillers.

But with scoring rates surging in recent seasons, the phenomenon has become increasingly common. Of the 33 losing centuries in IPL history, 16, nearly 50%, have

